PassFrame tuition

Commas & Apostrophes

Year 4 Pt 2 — Mark Scheme — Lesson Worksheet & Homework (tutor copy)

Lesson Worksheet — Answers

Easy / Standard

1. We packed shorts, shirts, socks and hats.

2. The cat's tail was fluffy.

3. don't

4. Tom's bike was red.

5. For breakfast I had toast, eggs and juice.

6. can't

7. The teacher's desk was tidy.

8. A — Suddenly, the lights went out.

9. she'll

10. My sister's bag is blue.

11. The shop sells pens, pencils, rulers and erasers.

12. they're

13. The dog's lead snapped.

14. I wanted to go, but I stayed home.

15. I'm

Standard

1. The boys' changing room was busy.

2. The men's football match was exciting.

3. It's

4. My dad, who works nights, was tired.

5. The two teams' scores were level.

6. After the storm, the streets flooded.

7. its

8. The ladies' coats hung by the door.

9. A, C and E (the men's, the class's and the workers' are all correctly punctuated; B should be "men's" since men is already plural, D should be "class's")

10. The museum, which opened in 1990, is free to enter.

11. The class's trophy was shining.

12. Yes, I would love to come.

13. the puppies' toys

14. Please, James, pass the salt.

15. Who's

Standard / Hard

1. "Jack and Emma's parents" means they share the same parents (joint possession). "Jack's and Emma's parents" means each has their own separate parents (individual possession).

2. James's book was on the table (or James' book) — for a singular name ending in s, add 's; James's is generally preferred in modern UK style.

3. "1990's" wrongly uses an apostrophe to form a plural of a number; it should be "1990s".

6. However, I still think we should go, even though it might rain. — a comma follows the introductory "However", and another separates the two linked ideas.

7. The boss's office was locked.

8. Comma splice — two independent clauses joined only by a comma. Correction: "The dog ran, and it barked loudly." (or use a semicolon).

11. B, C and D (It's / Whose coat is this? It's very muddy / no error to fix here — accept B and C; D is also correct grammar even with different word order; A should be "It's", E should be "boss's")

12. The Amazon rainforest, which covers much of Brazil, is under threat.

13. "The dogs' owner" means the owner of more than one dog (plural possessive). "The dog's owner" means the owner of one dog (singular possessive).

4. My brother, who lives in Leeds, is visiting. (commas needed — since there is only one brother, the clause is extra, non-essential information).

5. "p's and q's" uses apostrophes to show the plural of single letters, because "ps and qs" without apostrophes would be confusing to read.

9. the witnesses' opinions

10. "Your's" is never correct because possessive pronouns never take an apostrophe; the correct form is simply "yours".

14. It was a cold, dark, windy night.

15. "Its'" is never correct because the possessive pronoun "its" never takes an apostrophe (unlike "it's", the contraction of "it is").

Homework — Answers

Easy / Standard

1. I need a pen, a ruler, a rubber and a pencil.

2. The boy's football was flat.

3. didn't

4. Anna's coat was on the hook.

5. For lunch we had soup, bread and cheese.

6. won't

7. The doctor's office was busy.

8. A — Finally, the bus arrived.

9. he's

10. My brother's room is messy.

11. The bag held books, pens, keys and a phone.

12. we're

13. The cat's bowl was empty.

14. She wanted to stay, but she had to leave.

15. you're

Standard

1. The girls' changing room was locked.

2. The men's locker room was busy.

3. It's

4. My aunt, who lives abroad, is visiting.

5. The two teams' trophy was shared.

6. Before the match, the players warmed up.

7. its

8. The ladies' bags were lined up neatly.

9. A, C and E (the men's, the team's and the workers' are all correctly punctuated; B should be "men's" since men is already plural, D should be "team's")

10. The bridge, which was built long ago, is closed.

11. The team's captain scored twice.

12. No, I haven't finished yet.

13. the foxes' homes

14. Please, Aisha, open the window.

15. Whose

Standard / Advanced

1. "1980's" wrongly uses an apostrophe for a plural number; it should be "1980s".

2. Chris's bag was heavy (or Chris' bag) — for a singular name ending in s, add 's; Chris's is generally the

6. "The players' kits were muddy, but the captain's kit somehow stayed clean." — players' shows plural possession, captain's shows singular possession, and a comma is needed before "but".

7. Comma splice — two independent clauses joined only by a comma. Correction: "The bell rang, and the

11. A, C and E (dos and don'ts, The 1980s, and Sam's and Priya's projects are all correctly punctuated; B and D wrongly add apostrophes to plurals)

12. It was a bright, cheerful, sunny morning.

preferred modern UK style.

3. "Sam and Priya's project" means they share one project (joint possession). "Sam's and Priya's projects" means each has a separate project (individual possession).

4. "Her's" is never correct because possessive pronouns never take an apostrophe; the correct form is simply "hers".

5. "The boys' coach" means the coach belonging to more than one boy (plural possession). "The boy's coach" means the coach belonging to one boy (singular possession).

pupils lined up." (or use a semicolon).

8. The Great Barrier Reef, which is visible from space, is dying.

9. Possessive pronouns (its, yours, hers, ours, theirs) never take an apostrophe, so "its'" and "your's" are always incorrect — only "it's" (it is) is a correct apostrophe form.

10. the children's toys

13. No — it needs correcting: "Mind your dos and don'ts" — "dos" has no apostrophe (plural of "do"), and "don'ts" only needs the apostrophe for the contraction "don't", not for the plural.

14. Actually, I think we should leave now, although the film isn't finished.

15. "Well, I suppose Maria's plan, which nobody had heard before, could work; however, we should check the weather first."